

State of Maryland

Administrator's Report - January 22, 2026

Important Announcements and Meetings

The Maryland General Assembly came into session on January 14. We are monitoring all legislation, including our departmental requests including:

- SB91/HB265 - ACP Enrollee Management
- SB11/HB260 - Earlier Distributions from Fair Campaign Financing Fund
- SB100/HB263 - Early Voting Bus Stops
- SB153/HB267 - Campaign Finance - Control of Funds

Candidacy and Campaign Finance (CCF) Division

Between November 27 and January 13, there were 86 new committees established.

2026 Gubernatorial Elections

SBE has filed 338 candidates so far. Every candidate who files this year must file another financial disclosure statement in 2026 in order to appear on the ballot. SBE will send notices to those candidates beginning in January 2026. The candidate filing deadline is February 24, 2026.

MD CRIS/BCDS Replacement Update

The Maryland Contribution Reporting Information System (MD CRIS) went live on December 5. The project is currently in the Operations and Maintenance (O&M) phase of the contract. The first report due in the new MD CRIS system is the Annual 2026 Report, which is due on Wednesday, January 21, at 11:59 PM.

The training for filers has been successful, and the feedback has been positive, allowing staff to identify any gaps in the system from the filer's perspective. Additionally, the vendor has scheduled an open Zoom call from January 15 to January 22 to assist filers with any issues or questions. The vendor will also be available on-site for any support needed during the filing of the Annual 2026 Report.

Public Outreach

As we approach the end of the 2026 Annual reporting cycle, our MD CRIS training sessions have seen great engagement from users. To date, the CCF department has conducted 28 out of the 32 scheduled training sessions, providing hands-on instruction to 478 participants. These sessions were designed to ensure that every user is fully prepared for their submission by covering critical aspects of the reporting process and offering direct technical support.

To ensure compliance among businesses employing lobbyists, we executed a proactive outreach campaign on November 10, 2025. A 'Notice of Possible Filing Obligation' was sent to entities registered with the Maryland State Ethics Commission but not yet with the State Board of Elections. The impact of this outreach has been significant in that 245 businesses have since successfully

registered on the Maryland Business Contribution Disclosure System (MD BCDS).

On January 12, 2026, we hosted a focused press event and showcase for members of the media, university representatives, and independent researchers to demonstrate the capabilities of the newly upgraded MD CRIS and MD BCDS. This event has a strong turnout with 23 attendees participating both in person and virtually.

Public Financing (PF)

Currently, there are 50 active public financed (PF) committees. There are three candidates who have closed out their PF committee, which is not part of the 50 active accounts. As a comparison, by January 13th in an election year, there were 37 PF committees in the 2018 cycle. In the 2022 cycle at the same time, there were 27 PF committees. In the 2024 City elections there were 5 committees registered.

As of	Counties	PF Cmt	Initial Submission by 1/13 in the year of the primary
1/13/2018	Montgomery	37	9
1/13/2022	Montgomery & Howard	23+4	9+1
1/13/2024	Baltimore City	5	2
1/13/2026	Maryland (Governor), Montgomery, Howard, Prince George's, Baltimore Co., and Anne Arundel	50	11

Eleven public financed candidates are certified/qualified as of January 13, 2026. A first for the PF program, the committee 'Neighbors for Julie Yang' CCF ID: 15015511, maxed out on her initial Matching Fund Report (MFR).

As of January 12, 2025, there is \$10,570,687.29 in the State Fair Campaign Fund. This means the program can fully fund 2 Primary candidates and 1 candidate in the General. No additional funding is needed.

Enforcement

Listed below are the civil penalties paid in December 2025. The total amount collected is \$1,350:

- Cockey, Robert Bob Citizens to Elect - \$600 - Failure to maintain account books and records - Contribution/Expenditure records.
- Barclay, Christopher Friends Of - \$500 - Failure to maintain account books and records - Bank records
- Neighbors of Evan Glass \$125 - Failure to include authority line or authority line is insufficient.
- Zach Schulz for Harford - \$125 - Failure to include authority line or authority line is

insufficient.

Communications

Social Media presence remains a priority to ensure voters know their elected officials are their trusted sources for election information.

We are in the final stages of planning for an aggressive voter outreach campaign focusing on voter education. The campaign includes a landing page that allows people to upload the election calendar to an individual's phone and provides information on how to register to vote, become an election judge and methods of voting. There will continue to be paid outreach focusing on election judge recruitment and voter education leading up to the 2026 Primary and General elections. There will also be resources provided to local boards for the use of organic social media content to supplement the outreach campaign. Internally, we will utilize their own organic social media content to target mis/disinformation through voter education materials and videos.

LBEs will have the opportunity to order a new 2026 "Maryland Voter" sticker celebrating the 250th anniversary of the Declaration of Independence in place of the typical "I Voted" sticker.

The SBE Official Voter Resource app is in testing stages. We are hoping to launch the app mid-February which will be a wonderful resource for voters during the 2026 elections.

Election Management & Compliance

Contractual Staffing for Election

Core trainers have been onboarded and trainers are being hired for election judge training.

Language Assistance Implementation:

Staff has been working to implement the new state requirements for language assistance. Among other things, a determination was made as to what counties and languages will be covered. An interpretation service, the Language Line, will be provided to those counties. Additionally, various election materials are being translated into the covered languages. If LBEs want to have additional documents or languages, a request will be submitted using a form prescribed by SBE.

Information Systems & Technology

Applications

Release 10.5 of MDVOTERS will be deployed on February 20, 2026. The release will include an overhaul of Voter Registration Correspondence and mail in ballot enhancements.

Reporting

The Joint Chairman's Report for *MAJOR INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY DEVELOPMENT PROJECT (MITDP) ACTIVITIES AND SPENDING* is on target for January 15, 2026

Information Security

No updates

Mail-In Voting (MIV)

Permanent Absentee Removals

Later this month, SBE will remove approximately 11,000 voters from the Permanent Absentee Ballot list in accordance with Maryland Election Law §9-311.1. Voters will be removed if they haven't voted with their mail-in ballot in the last two statewide general elections. The LBEs will mail each voter a letter explaining this action. This action does not cancel a voter's registration, and voters can sign-up for an MIB again if they choose.

Online Mail-In Ballot Requests

Voters requesting a mail-in ballot via the Online Mail-in Ballot Request (OMIR) system will now be required to go through a verification process requiring the voter to be currently registered in our database before proceeding with the request. The voter will be redirected to the Online Voter Registration (OLVR) screen if their information cannot be verified. This will prevent unregistered voters from requesting a mail-in ballot during the close of registration period.

Personnel Management

Worcester is beginning recruitment for a new Deputy Director.

HR is currently working on getting the Federal Injury Report completed. This shows all injuries that happened within a calendar year. SBE had 0 for 2025.

Procurement

Active Procurements

- 1) *The New Voting System (NVS)*: RFP D38B5600001 was published on June 27, 2025. On September 5, 2025 SBE received 4 offers in response to the solicitation. One Offeror withdrew their proposal. The RFP is planned for deployment in the 2028 election. The BAFO process will be underway this week.
- 2) *Managed Security Services*: RFP D38B6600005- The MSS RFP for a managed security services provider is in the final stages of RFP creation and will be submitted for DoIT review shortly. The purpose of this solicitation is to procure a security contract that strengthens the agency's cybersecurity operations, engineering capabilities, and enterprise risk management. The selected contractor will provide managed security operations, specialized engineering expertise, and strategic advisory services to support the continued maturation of the agency's Cyber Security Division.
- 3) *MDVOTERS V Data Center*: RFP D38B6600007- The MDVOTERS V hosting services RFP is in the final development stages. The purpose of this contract is for Data Center (DC) hosting services, including hardware for several election systems, network

administration, and DC migration/relocation services, and a managed services provider for the data centers. The primary DC is also referred to as the Voter Registration Operations Center (VROC) throughout this document. Additionally requirements include the management and operations of the Continuity of Operations Center (COOP) data center.

Recent Awards:

- 1) Statewide Pollbook Modernization: BPW approved SBE's pollbook award on 12/3/2025. The contract is slated to start in January 2026.
- 2) Tamper Evident Labels: Novavision has started sending tamper evident labels to LBEs effective 1/13/2026. LBEs may receive an email directly from Novavision regarding delivery information Novavision. The grand total is \$48,075.66.

Requests for Information:

- 1) Automated Ballot Tabulation Audit Contract: We are planning to post an RFI for information on additional vendor options for the Clear Ballot contract to determine if this is still a sole source or if other vendors have entered the marketplace.

Voter Registration, Audits & Operations

Internal Audits

Monthly audits of voter registration data continue to verify compliance with federal and state laws governing voter registration.

Non-Citizens

Non-citizen referrals are, in general, sent to the State Prosecutor's office on a quarterly basis. Fourth quarter 2025 referrals were made on January 16, 2026.

The following summarizes relevant activity from 4th Quarter 2025:

Submitted to the Office of the State Prosecutor - 19

Removal of non-citizens - 19

Removal of non-citizens who voted - 16

Removal of non-citizens who voted multiple times - 7

Non-citizens reported by Immigration & Customs Enforcement - 0

Change in status from Office of the State Prosecutor - 0

Election Operations

The Election Operations has finalized the Election Judge, Same Day Registration, and Address Change Manuals for the 2026 election cycle and provided these to all local boards of elections. We are in the process of reviewing each LBE's customization of manuals and forms so that they are compliant and standardized. We continue to track election judge recruitment, pay rates, and training schedules in preparation for the 2026 Gubernatorial Primary.

We continue our work with *Voting Works* and SBE and LBE stakeholders to implement Risk Limiting Audits for the upcoming 2026 election cycle in congruence with SB 313 (2025). This audit will replace the manual audit and complement our automated tabulation audit by verifying the outcome of the election prior to state certification.

Registration & Election Management Database (MDVOTERS)

ERIC Reports for November were received. This is our first Cross State report since ERIC has loaded New Jersey data. In-State Updates are up, this is 3 months worth of data instead of 2 months.

NCOA: 130,736

In-State Updates: 84,906

Cross-State: 20,082

The Current Total Registered Voters as of January 2, 2026 was 4,299,525 active voters in Maryland.

Motor Vehicle Administration (MVA) Transactions

During December 2025, MVA collected the following voter registration transactions:

New Registration - 8,408

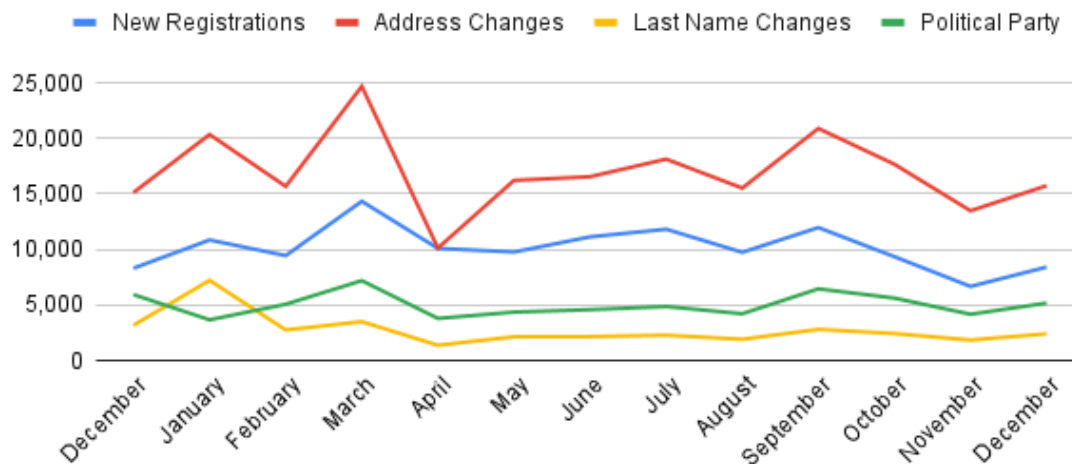
Residential Address Changes - 15,733

Last Name Changes - 2,400

Political Party - 5,165

Last 13 Months of MVA Transactions - Chart:

MVA Transactions December 2024 to December 2025



MVA Transactions - Monthly Changes:

New Registrations	Address Changes	Last Name	Political Party
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Nov-2025				
Month-to-Month - Change	-28.6%	-23.7%	-24.0%	-25.9%
Same Month - Previous Year Change	2056.6%	1101.8%	417.1%	1591.1%
Same Month - 2 Years Ago Change	-31.3%	-11.4%	-28.9%	-9.9%
Dec-2025				
Month-to-Month - Change	26.2%	16.8%	30.4%	24.2%
Same Month - Previous Year Change	1.3%	4.1%	-24.3%	-12.9%
Same Month - 2 Years Ago Change	8.7%	25.3%	14.4%	30.2%

MSR- Removals

Maryland State Board of Elections Summary of Voter Registration Activity Report November2025

REMOVALS									
	DEM	REP	GRN	WCP	UNA	OTH	UNAF	OTH	TOTAL
BOARD ACTION	0	0	0	0	0	0			0
CONFIRMATION MAILING	8	7	0	0	6	0			21
COUNTY TRANSFER	4215	1696	10	8	1991	163			8,083
CRIMINAL CONVICTION	58	9	1	1	18	3			90
DEATH NOTICE	1359	774	0	1	352	42			2,528
DUPLICATE	25	7	0	0	1	0			33
MAIL VERIFICATION	1040	513	5	2	581	46			2,187
MENTAL INCOMPETENCE	0	0	0	0	0	0			0
MOVED OUT OF STATE	554	375	0	0	275	23			1,227
OTHER	61	17	0	0	65	14			157
VOTER REQUEST	69	26	1	0	44	0			140
TOTAL	7,389	3,424	17	12	3,333	291		0	14,466

Exercise of Delegated Duties

We will use this section of the State Administrator's Report to report when we have exercised duties assigned to the State Board of Elections but delegated to the State Administrator and staff.

Since the last State Administrator's Report:

 x No delegated duties were exercised.

 The following delegated duties were exercised.